



What makes a hero?

1 Look at the pictures and the title of the article on page 35. Then read the first paragraph. What is the article about?

- 1 people who are called heroes, but who didn't do anything special
- 2 heroes who are not very famous or well known
- 3 qualities that every hero should have

2 Study the reading strategy. Then read the article. Which of the **highlighted** sentences (1–8) are facts (F)? Which are opinions (O)?



Reading strategy

Identifying facts and opinions

It's important to recognize facts and opinion. A fact is true and can be proven. It's based on evidence or research. An opinion is what a person thinks or feels. It's based on a point of view or a belief.

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|---------|---------|
| 1 | 5 |
| 2 | 6 |
| 3 | 7 |
| 4 | 8 |

3 Read the article again. Find one more fact and one more opinion about each person.

Junko Tabei

- 1 Fact:
- 2 Opinion:

Svetlana Savitskaya

- 3 Fact:
- 4 Opinion:

Scott Fahlman

- 5 Fact:
- 6 Opinion:

4 Decide if these sentences are true (T) or false (F).

- 1 An unsung hero is someone who wants to be a hero, but hasn't actually done anything special.
- 2 Junko Tabei became a great climber because she spent many hours climbing as a child.
- 3 After she graduated from college, a lot of climbing expeditions wouldn't allow Junko to climb with them.
- 4 Junko was the first person to climb the "seven summits."
- 5 Svetlana Savitskaya is one of the fastest pilots ever.
- 6 The writer thinks that the first woman in space is probably more famous than the second woman in space.
- 7 Svetlana went on to become an important military leader.
- 8 Scott Fahlman was the first to draw this smiley face 😊.
- 9 When smileys were first invented, people typed them like this: :-).
- 10 Scott's invention allowed people to express happiness and sadness in online communication.

5 Answer the questions. Use ideas from the article on page 35.

- 1 Do you think all three of the unsung heroes are true heroes? Why? / Why not?

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- 2 Can you think of anybody who is an unsung hero? Give examples of things he/she did.

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UNSUNG HEROES

Reading to learn



Heroes are recognized as courageous leaders – people who help others or make the world a better place. We read about them in the news. They receive awards. Unsung heroes, on the other hand, achieve great things, but don't receive much recognition for their actions. I'd like to tell you about three unsung heroes, and hopefully you'll agree that people should know more about them.

THE MOUNTAIN CLIMBER

When she was very young, Junko Tabei (1939–2016) was not strong or healthy. But she had a dream: to climb mountains. Growing up, she had few opportunities to climb. But then she joined the climbing club at her college, and by the time she graduated, she was an excellent climber. However, many male climbers refused to allow her to join their expeditions, mainly because she was a woman. As a result, she started the Ladies Climbing Club in Japan in 1969 and began organizing all-female expeditions. ¹In 1975, she became the first woman to climb Mount Everest, the world's tallest peak. And she continued climbing until she'd been to the top of the highest mountain on all seven continents – the so-called “seven summits.” She was the first woman to do so. ²Too little is known about Tabei around the world. She showed great determination, and her life in the mountains was amazing. ³Such a courageous climber should be a world-famous hero!



THE ASTRONAUT

Russian adventurer Svetlana Savitskaya (1948–) is another amazing person.

⁴She began skydiving at 16, and at 17, made a record-breaking jump from 14,252 meters. The next year, she began training as a pilot, and eventually set 23 world records for speed. Some still haven't been broken. At the age of 32, she started training to fly in space. ⁵In 1981, she became the second woman in space – not the first. Maybe this is why she isn't very famous. After retiring from space flight, she demonstrated her leadership skills by entering politics. More people should know about this incredible woman and her achievements!



THE INVENTOR

⁶In modern communication (texting, emails, social media), many of us use emoticons – symbols that show our mood. Today they look like this: 😊 They're a simple, powerful way to communicate emotion. But until a few years ago, everyone typed them as sideways faces: :-)

On September 19, 1982, computer scientist Scott Fahlman suggested that people posting messages on his university's electronic message board mark jokes with a smiling face and serious comments with a frowning face. ⁷I think this makes him a hero of modern communication.

⁸Junko Tabei, Svetlana Savitskaya, and Scott Fahlman are all unsung heroes. I hope that you feel as inspired by them as I do.

